Austria,[d] formally the **Republic of Austria**,[e] is a landlocked country in Central Europe, lying in the Eastern Alps.[14] It is a federation of nine states, of which the capital Vienna is the most populous city and state. Austria is bordered by Germany to the northwest, the Czech Republic to the north, Slovakia to the northeast, Hungary to the east, Slovenia and Italy to the south, and Switzerland and Liechtenstein to the west. The country occupies an area of 83,879 km^2 (32,386 sq mi) and has a population of around 9 million.[9]

The area of today's Austria has been inhabited since at least the Paleolithic period. Around 400 BC, it was inhabited by the Celts and then annexed by the Romans in the late 1st century BC. Christianization in the region began in the 4th and 5th centuries, during the late Roman period, followed by the arrival of numerous Germanic tribes during the Migration Period.[15]

Austria, as a unified state, emerged from the remnants of the Eastern and Hungarian March at the end of the first millennium, first as a frontier march of the Holy Roman Empire, it then developed into a Duchy in 1156, and was made an Archduchy in 1453. Being the heartland of the Habsburg monarchy since the late 13th century, Austria was a major imperial power in Central Europe for centuries and from the 16th century, Vienna also served as the Holy Roman Empire's administrative capital.[16] The Holy Roman Empire was dissolved in 1806, two years after Austria had established its own empire, which became a great power and one of the largest states in Europe. The empire's defeat in wars and the loss of territories in the 1860s paved the way for the establishment of Austria-Hungary in 1867.[17] After the assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand in 1914, Emperor Franz Joseph declared war on Serbia, which

rapidly escalated into World War I. The empire's defeat and subsequent collapse led to the proclamation of the Republic of German-Austria in 1918 and the First Austrian Republic in 1919. During the interwar period, anti-parliamentarian sentiments culminated in the formation of an Austrofascist dictatorship under Engelbert Dollfuss in 1934. A year before the outbreak of World War II, Austria was annexed into Nazi Germany by Adolf Hitler, and it became a sub-national division. After its liberation in 1945 and a decade of Allied occupation, the country regained its sovereignty and declared its perpetual neutrality in 1955. Austria is a semi-presidential[f] representative democracy with a popularly elected president as head of state and a chancellor as head of government and chief executive. Austria has the 13th highest nominal GDP per capita with high standards of living. The country has been a member of the United Nations since 1955[19] and of the European Union since 1995.[20] It hosts the Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE) and the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) and is a founding member of the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) and Interpol.[21] It also signed the Schengen Agreement in 1995,[22] and adopted the euro currency in 1999.[23]

Etymology

Main article: Name of Austria

The native name for Austria, *Österreich*, derives from the Old High German *Ostarrîchi*, which meant "eastern realm", can be also translated as "eastern empire" or "eastern kingdom", and which first appeared in the "Ostarrîchi document" of 996.[24][25] This word is probably a translation of Medieval Latin *Marchia orientalis* into a local (Bavarian) dialect.

Austria was a prefecture of Bavaria created in 976. The word "Austria" is a Latinisation of the German name and was first recorded in the 12th century.[26] At the time, the Danube basin of Austria (Upper and Lower Austria) was the easternmost extent of Bavaria.

Austria's capital and largest city is Vienna (48°12′N 16°21′E). The official and national language is Austrian German, and the official regional languages are Hungarian, Slovene, and Burgenland Croatian. In 2024, the population was listed as 72.2% Austrians and 27.8% other. By religion (2021), 68.2% identified as Christian (including 55.2% Catholic, 4.9% Orthodox, 3.8% Protestant, and **4.3% other Christian), 22.4% reported no religion, 8.3% identified as Muslim, and 1.1% as other. The demonym is Austrian. Austria is a federal state and is described as a semi-presidential republic (de jure) and a parliamentary republic (de facto). The President is Alexander Van der Bellen and the Chancellor is Christian Stocker. The legislature is the Parliament, with the Federal Council as the upper house and the National Council as the lower house.
Key historical milestones listed include: **Margraviate (1 November 996)**, **Duchy (17 September 1156)**, **Archduchy (6 January 1453)**, **Imperial circle (1512)**, **Empire (11 August 1804)**, **Austria-Hungary (30 March 1867)**, **First Republic (10 September 1919)**, **Federal State (1 May 1934)**, **Anschluss (13 March 1938)**, **Second Republic (27 April 1945)**, and the **State Treaty (27 July 1955)**.
Austria covers a total area of **83,879 km²** (32,386 sq mi), with **0.84%** water (2015). The **2024** population estimate is **9,110,079**, with a density of **107.6 people per km²** (278.7 per sq mi). For the economy, **GDP (PPP, 2025 estimate)** is

$682.86 billion (**$74,370 per capita**), and **GDP (nominal, 2025 estimate)** is **$534.30 billion** (**$58,190 per capita**). The **Gini coefficient (2023)** is **28.1** (low inequality), and the **HDI (2023)** is **0.930** (very high).
The currency is the **Euro (€)**. The time zone is **UTC+1 (CET)**, with **UTC+2 (CEST)** in summer (DST). The calling code is **+43**, the ISO 3166 code is **AT**, and the internet TLD is **.at**.

Vienna (/viˈɛnə/ ⓘ *vee-EN-ə*;[8][9] German: *Wien* [viːn] ⓘ;

Austro-Bavarian: *Wean* [veɐ̯n]) is the capital, most populous city, and one of the nine states of Austria. It is Austria's primate city, with just over two million inhabitants.[10][11] Its larger metropolitan area has a population of nearly 2.9 million,[12] representing nearly one-third of the country's population. Vienna is the cultural, economic, and political center of the country, the fifth-largest city by population in the European Union, and the most populous of the cities on the river Danube.
The city lies on the eastern edge of the Vienna Woods (*Wienerwald*), the northeasternmost foothills of the Alps, that separate Vienna from the more western parts of Austria, at the transition to the Pannonian Basin. It sits on the Danube, and is traversed by the highly regulated Wienfluss (*Vienna River*). Vienna is completely surrounded by Lower Austria, and lies around 50 km (31 mi) west of Slovakia and its capital Bratislava, 50 km (31 mi) northwest of Hungary, and 60 km (37 mi) south of Moravia (Czech Republic).
The Romans founded a castrum at Vienna, which they called *Vindobona*, in the 1st century, when the region belonged to the province of Pannonia. It was elevated to a

municipium with Roman city rights in 212. This was followed by a time in the sphere of influence of the Lombards and later the Pannonian Avars, when Slavs formed the majority of the region's population.[a] From the 8th century on, the region was settled by the Baiuvarii. In 1155, Vienna became the seat of the Babenbergs, who ruled Austria from 976 to 1246. In 1221, Vienna was granted city rights. During the 16th century, the Habsburgs, who had succeeded the Babenbergs, established Vienna as the seat of the emperors of the Holy Roman Empire, a position it held until the empire's dissolution in 1806, with only a brief interruption. With the formation of the Austrian Empire in 1804, Vienna became the capital of it and all its successor states.

Throughout the modern era, Vienna has been among the largest German-speaking cities in the world. It was the largest in the 18th and 19th centuries, peaking at two million inhabitants before it was overtaken by Berlin at the beginning of the 20th century.[13][14][15] Vienna is host to many major international organizations, including the United Nations, OPEC and the OSCE. In 2001, the city center was designated a UNESCO World Heritage Site. In July 2017, it was moved to the list of World Heritage in Danger.[16]

Vienna is renowned for its rich musical heritage, having been home to many celebrated classical composers, including Beethoven, Brahms, Bruckner, Haydn, Mahler, Mozart, Schoenberg, Schubert, Johann Strauss I, and Johann Strauss II.[17] It played a pivotal role as a leading European music center, from the age of Viennese Classicism through the early part of the 20th century. The city was home to the world's first psychoanalyst, Sigmund Freud.[18] The historic center of Vienna is rich in architectural ensembles, including Baroque palaces and gardens, and

the late-19th-century *Ringstraße*, which is lined with grand buildings, monuments and parks.[19]

Etymology

See also: Names of European cities in different languages: U–Z § V

The precise origin of the name is uncertain. Vienna was known to the Romans as *Vindobona*, a borrowing of a Celtic toponym meaning either "white place" or "place of Vindos" (a personal name).[20] This name disappeared from the record after the 6th century, occurring for the last time in Jordanes' *Getica*. The German name for the city, *Wien* – of which *Vienna* is a Latinized form – is unrelated, deriving from the River Wien (compare Steyr, Enns, and Krems, which all take their names from the rivers whose mouths they lie at). It occurs for the first time in the Salzburg Annals, which note that a battle was fought at a place named *Wenia* in the year 881. The name may ultimately mean "forest river", from Celtic **Vedunia*.[21]

Bécs, the Hungarian name for Vienna (borrowed into Serbo-Croatian as *Beč* and into Ottoman Turkish as *Beç*), probably derives from a word meaning "kiln", and may date from a period in the 10th century when the region came under temporary Hungarian domination.[22][23] In Romanian, the city is now called *Viena*, but the archaic names *Beci* and *Beciu* were used in chronicles. Romanian still has *beci* in use, a common noun meaning "cellar"; linguist Dan Alexe states both it and the aforementioned names of Vienna are believed to ultimately be derived from a word of the Turkic-speaking Avars, originally meaning "fortified place" or "treasury".[24][25]

In Slovene, the city is called *Dunaj*, which in other Slavic languages denotes the River Danube.

In the Bavarian dialect of eastern Austria, the city is called *Wean*; however, this name is hardly used to any significant extent in the local city dialect (Viennese German) anymore. [26]

Vienna is governed as both a **state and a municipality**. Its political leader serves as **Mayor and Governor**, a role currently held by **Michael Ludwig (SPÖ)**. The city covers a total area of **414.78 km²** (160.15 sq mi), made up of **395.25 km²** of land (152.61 sq mi) and **19.39 km²** of water (7.49 sq mi). Vienna's elevation ranges from **151 to 542 meters** (495–1,778 ft).

In **2025**, Vienna's population is listed as **2,028,499**, making it **1st in Austria** and **10th in Europe** by rank. The population density is **4,890.5 people per km²** (12,666 per sq mi). The **urban** population (the "Kernzone") is given as **2,223,236**, while the **metropolitan** population is **2,890,577**. In terms of ethnicity, the breakdown provided is **46% Austrian** and **54% other**. People from Vienna are called **Wiener** (male) and **Wienerin** (female) in German, and **Viennese** in English.

Economically, Vienna's **GDP (2024)** is listed as **€110.9 billion**, with a **GDP per capita** of **€56,600**. The city uses the time zone **UTC+01:00 (CET)**, switching to **UTC+02:00 (CEST)** during daylight saving time. Postal codes are mainly **1xx0** (where "xx" is the district number), with special codes including **1300** for the airport and **1400** for the United Nations, plus **1yyy** for postal boxes. Vienna's ISO 3166 code is **AT-9**, its vehicle registration code is **W**, and its local geoTLD is **.wien**. The city's **HDI (2022)** is **0.948**, described as *very high* and ranked **1st of 9**.

Vienna holds 10 of 60 seats in Austria's Federal Council. Its official website is wien.gv.at (in German). The Historic

Centre of Vienna is recognized as a UNESCO World Heritage Site, designated in 2001, with an area of 371 hectares(Reference No. 1033) in the UNESCO region Europe and North America. It has been listed as endangered from 2017 to the present.